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Information Systems & Digital Health Unit
MERQ Consultancy PLC
Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Junior Software Engineer – Digital Health & AI Solutions position with MERQ Consultancy PLC. As a Full-Stack Software Engineer with two years of experience building digital health and public-sector systems in Ethiopia, I am excited by the opportunity to bring that background to a unit focused on digital health, research platforms, and AI-enabled solutions.

In my current role at Development Gateway (an IREX Venture), seconded to the Ministry of Agriculture, I design and build full-stack systems using Django, React, and PostgreSQL that are used nationwide, including DOVAR, an animal disease tracking system, and a Planning & Performance Management System that automates report generation for the Ethiopian Parliament. Previously, at John Snow, Inc. (JSI), seconded to the Ministry of Health, I worked directly on digital health infrastructure: I co-developed the Digital Health Project Inventory (DHPI) system using Laravel and Vue.js to help the Ministry register and certify digital health solutions, contributed to the National Health Data Dictionary application, and supported DHIS2 configuration and its interoperability with the eCHIS platform. This experience gave me firsthand exposure to the responsible, privacy-conscious handling of health data that this role also emphasizes.

Across both roles, I have built and documented 50+ REST API endpoints, integrated systems with DHIS2, and used OpenTelemetry to monitor application health, skills that map directly onto the role's emphasis on REST APIs, system integrations, and secure software development practices. My core stack, JavaScript/React on the frontend and Python/Django or PHP/Laravel on the backend, aligns closely with the technologies MERQ uses, and I am comfortable picking up adjacent tools quickly, as I did with SharePoint, Odoo ERP, and DHIS2 in my current position.

While my production experience with Node.js, MongoDB, and applied AI/LLM tooling is still developing, I am eager to build on this foundation, and I have a track record of ramping up quickly on new platforms while delivering real systems under deadline. I am also drawn to the mentorship structure of this role and the chance to grow within a team working at the intersection of digital health and AI.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background in digital health and government systems could contribute to MERQ's Information Systems & Digital Health Unit. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Lydia Fikire